international relations is fading away, is ignoring the reality. It is true that the overwhelming control of the state over the lives and activities of its citizens or its external as well as internal concerns has loosened, but this has in no way affected its position as the premier form of political organization—a unit that provides myriad services to its people. It is clear that the state remains the only organization that can provide the two essential services that allow the society to survive—security and welfare broadly conceived. Forces of ethnicity, religious fundamentalism, terrorism, the 9/11 attacks on the World Trade Center, the London blasts, Jaipur blasts, serial blasts in Ahmedabad (July 2008), Bangalore (July 2008), and the recent Mumbai siege (26/11) 2008 are no doubt challenging the states' might, yet, states continue to be the dominant units in international relations and the decisions and actions of their governments and their interrelations still remain the focus of inquiry.

If one considers the case of state vis-à-vis the non-state actors, one is sure to conclude that non-state actors work towards realization of their specific interests, few of which may be directly resulting in war or peace. But, even then, the governments remain the primary arbiters in these matters. As Holsti[22] contends, states remain critical actors in international politics because:

1. They command the allegiance of people occupying a definite territory.
2. They are the ones who possess the capabilities to employ the ultimate threat (war).
3. They, unlike the transnational organizations, are concerned with allround development, welfare and security of their population.
4. Only states enjoy sovereignty.

Frankel also explains that "by the end of the seventies, when the scattered residual remains of colonial empires were still achieving statehood and adding new, ostensibly even less 'viable' new members to the family of nations, no cases of disintegration or disappearance of a legitimate state had been recorded". The disintegration of Yugoslavia, Czechoslovakia and the Soviet Union in the late eighties and nineties had added to the number of states, but the world community did not experience any demise of territorial